

Linux Class 3 - Practice Task

Practice of the vi editor: modes, saving, moving, deleting and replacing

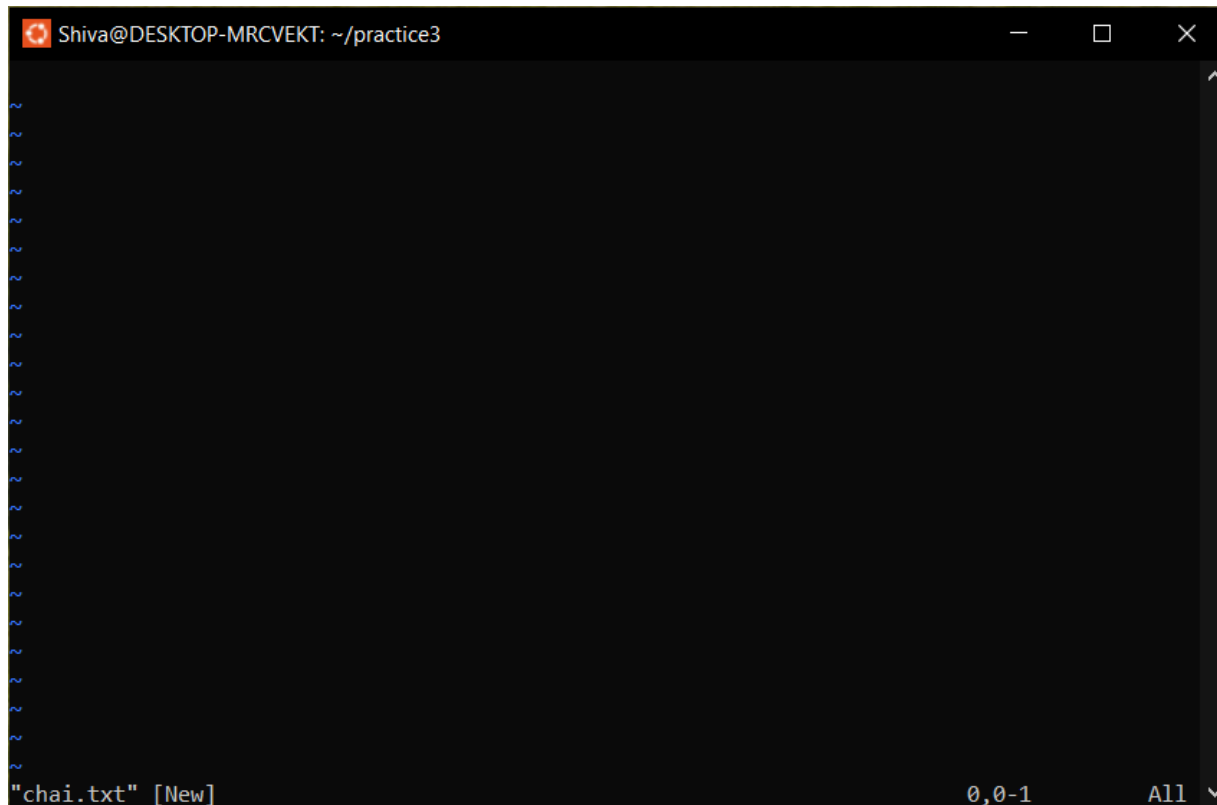
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This is my practice for class 3, the vi editor. I made a folder practice3 and made a small file about chai, because chai comes many times in it and it is good for search and replace.

Creating a file with vi

```
vi chai.txt
```

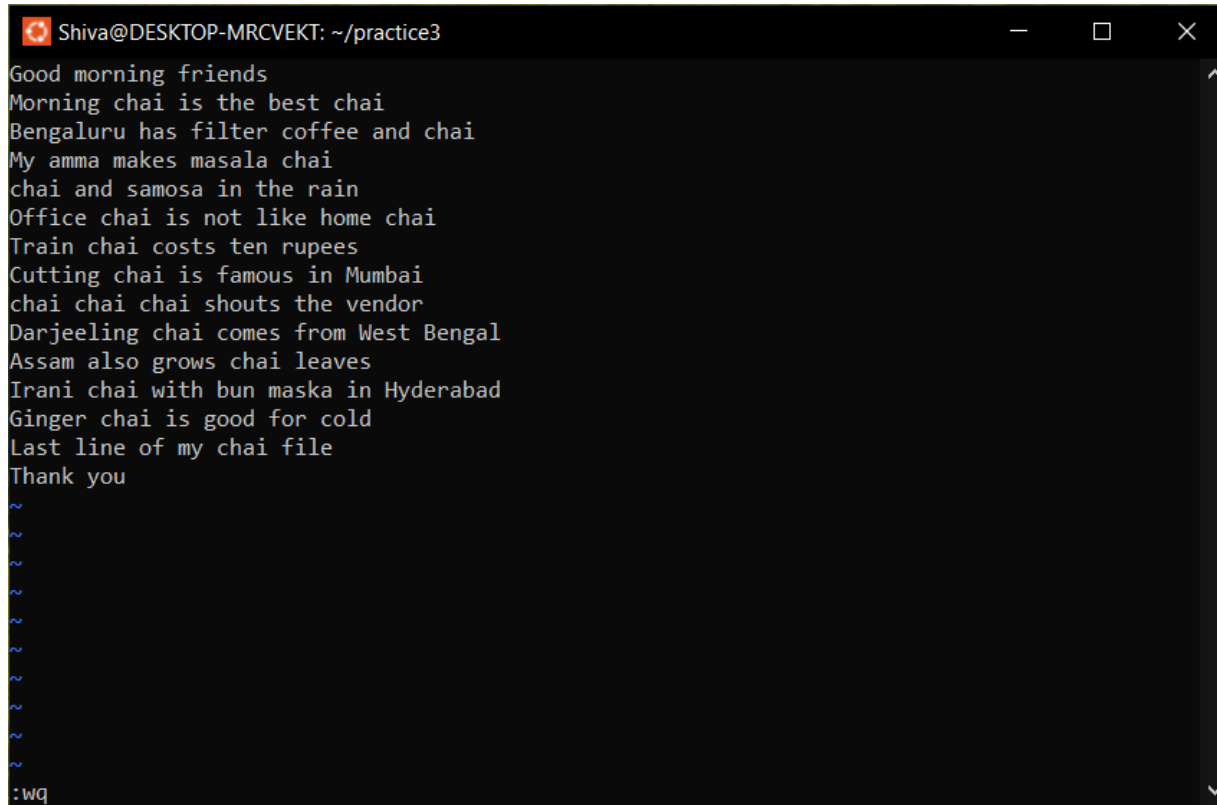


Screenshot 1: vi opened a new empty file.

chai.txt was not there before, so vi made a new file and opened it. At the bottom it says "chai.txt" [New]. The ~ marks on the left mean those lines are empty.

vi opens in command mode. In command mode, whatever I type is a command, not text. To type text I pressed i to go to insert mode, and then typed 15 lines. To come back to command mode we press Esc. In my terminal Ctrl+C also brought me back to command mode, I used that.

Saving with :wq

A screenshot of a terminal window titled 'Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT: ~/practice3'. The terminal displays 15 lines of text: 'Good morning friends', 'Morning chai is the best chai', 'Bengaluru has filter coffee and chai', 'My amma makes masala chai', 'chai and samosa in the rain', 'Office chai is not like home chai', 'Train chai costs ten rupees', 'Cutting chai is famous in Mumbai', 'chai chai chai shouts the vendor', 'Darjeeling chai comes from West Bengal', 'Assam also grows chai leaves', 'Irani chai with bun maska in Hyderabad', 'Ginger chai is good for cold', 'Last line of my chai file', and 'Thank you'. Below these lines are five tilde (~) characters. At the bottom left, the command ':wq' is typed. The terminal window has standard Linux window controls (minimize, maximize, close) in the top right corner.

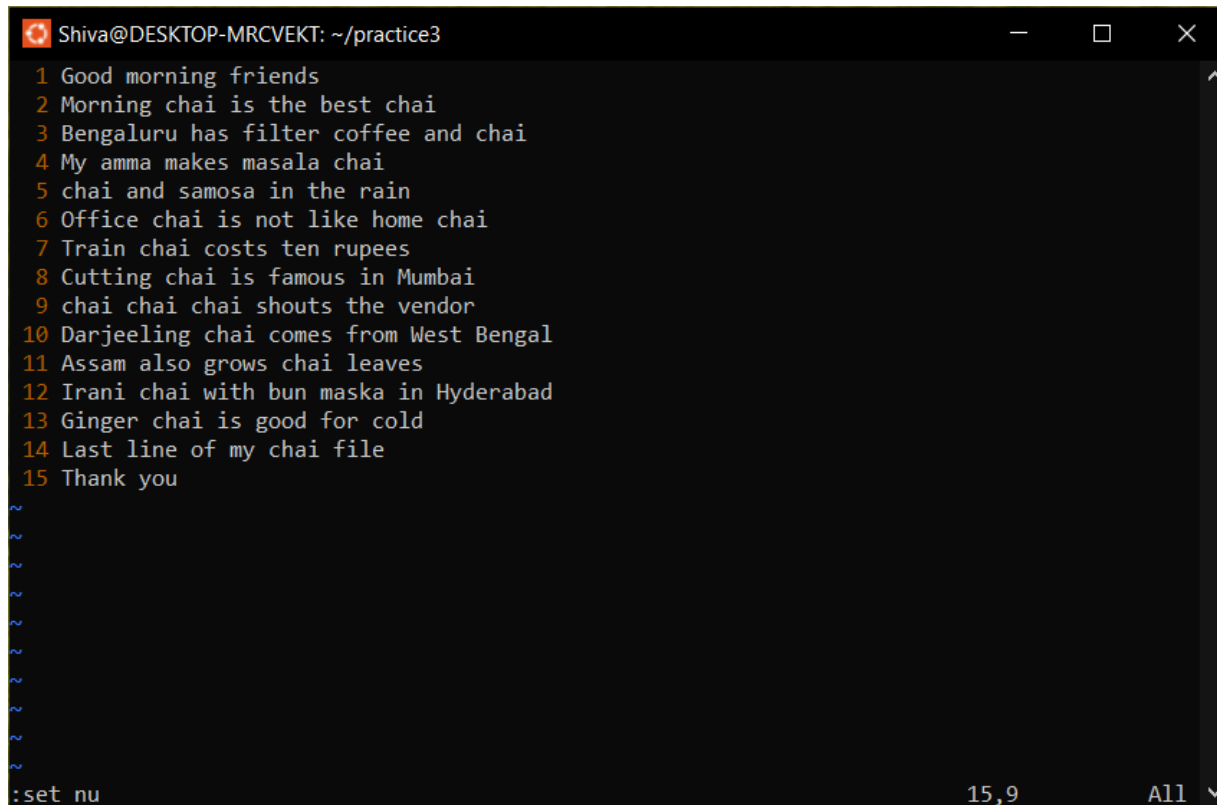
Screenshot 2: my 15 lines, and :wq typed at the bottom.

After typing, I typed :wq. It comes at the bottom left. w means write (save) and q means quit. After pressing Enter, the file was saved and I came back to the terminal.

Line numbers, moving, A and dd

I opened the file again and typed :set nu. nu means number.

```
:set nu
```

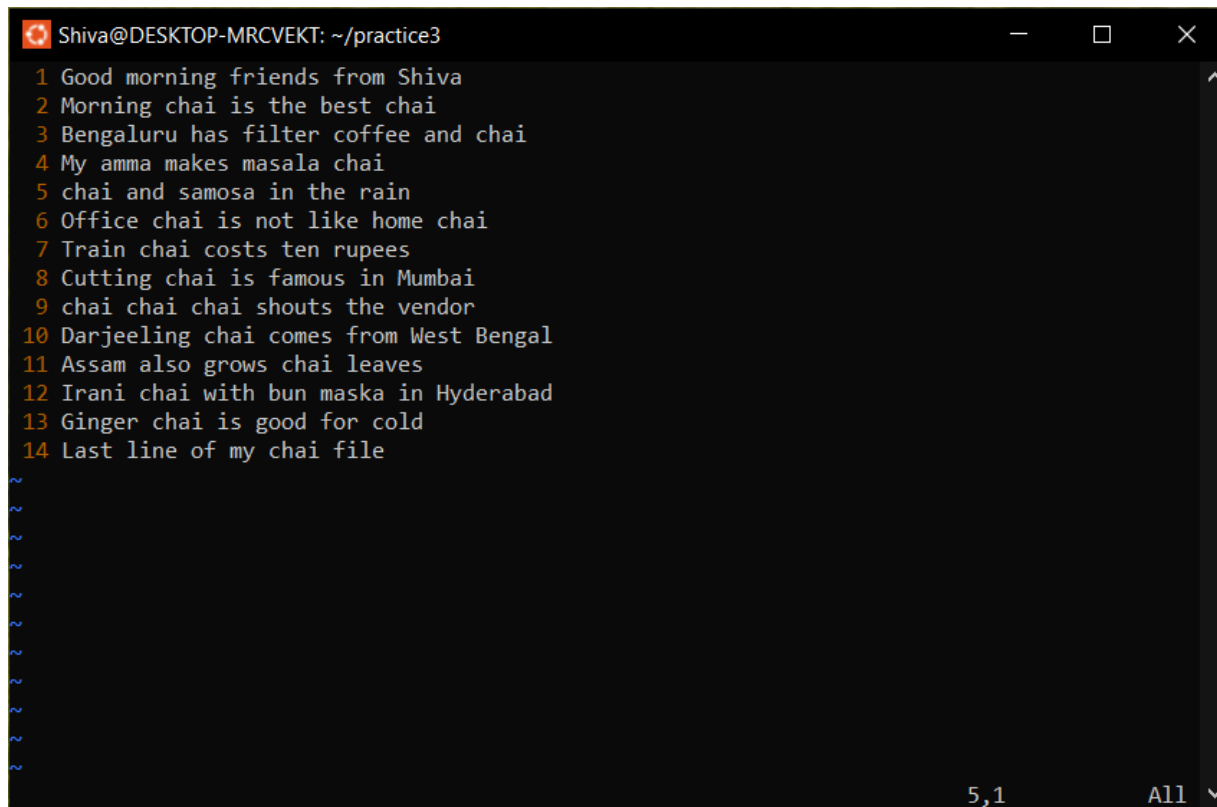
A screenshot of a terminal window titled "Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT: ~/practice3". The terminal displays a file with 15 lines of text, each preceded by a line number from 1 to 15. The text is as follows:
1 Good morning friends
2 Morning chai is the best chai
3 Bengaluru has filter coffee and chai
4 My amma makes masala chai
5 chai and samosa in the rain
6 Office chai is not like home chai
7 Train chai costs ten rupees
8 Cutting chai is famous in Mumbai
9 chai chai chai shouts the vendor
10 Darjeeling chai comes from West Bengal
11 Assam also grows chai leaves
12 Irani chai with bun maska in Hyderabad
13 Ginger chai is good for cold
14 Last line of my chai file
15 Thank you
Below the 15th line, there are several tilde (~) characters. At the bottom left of the terminal, the command ":set nu" is entered. At the bottom right, the status bar shows "15,9" and "All".

Screenshot 3: line numbers after :set nu.

Now each line has a number on the left. This helps a lot with the commands below. :set nonu removes the numbers again.

Then I tried these, one after another:

- 1G - go to line 1. Then A - goes to the end of that line and starts insert mode. I typed " from Shiva" and came back to command mode.
- G - go to the last line. Then dd - deleted that line (Thank you).
- 5G - go to line 5. The cursor jumped to line 5.



```
Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT: ~/practice3
1 Good morning friends from Shiva
2 Morning chai is the best chai
3 Bengaluru has filter coffee and chai
4 My amma makes masala chai
5 chai and samosa in the rain
6 Office chai is not like home chai
7 Train chai costs ten rupees
8 Cutting chai is famous in Mumbai
9 chai chai chai shouts the vendor
10 Darjeeling chai comes from West Bengal
11 Assam also grows chai leaves
12 Irani chai with bun maska in Hyderabad
13 Ginger chai is good for cold
14 Last line of my chai file
~
~
~
~
~
~
~
~
~
~
5,1 All
```

Screenshot 4: line 1 has "from Shiva", the last line is gone, and the cursor is on line 5.

In the bottom right it shows 5,1, that means line 5 and column 1. So 5G worked. Line 15 "Thank you" is deleted, now the file has 14 lines. I saved this with :wq.

Search and replace

Now the main part. I opened the file again and replaced chai with tea in different ways, to see what each one does.

```
2G then :s/chai/tea/
6G then :s/chai/tea/g
:9s/chai/tea/g
:3,5s/chai/tea/
:10,$s/chai/tea/g
```

[illegible]

Screenshot 5: after all the replace commands.

Command	What happened in my file
2G then :s/chai/tea/	Line 2: only the first chai became tea
6G then :s/chai/tea/g	Line 6: both chai became tea
:9s/chai/tea/g	Line 9: all 3 chai became tea
:3,5s/chai/tea/	Lines 3 to 5: first chai in each line
:10,\$s/chai/tea/g	Line 10 to the last line: all chai

Lines 7 and 8 still say `chai`, because no command touched them. And line 2 still has one `chai` at the end, because without `g` only the first one changes. So `g` means all the matches in that line.

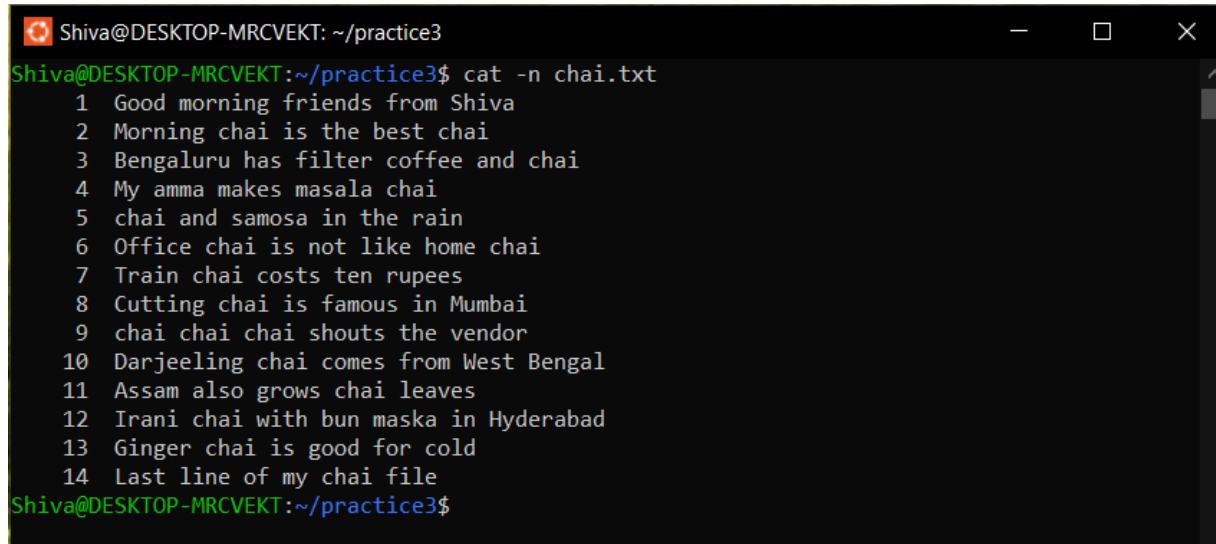
Number before s means which line. 5,10 means from line 5 to line 10. \$ means the last line.

Quit without saving - :q!

I did not want to keep tea in my chai file, so I came out with :q! without saving. Then I checked the file with cat.

```
:q!
```

```
cat -n chai.txt
```



```
Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT: ~/practice3
Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT:~/practice3$ cat -n chai.txt
 1 Good morning friends from Shiva
 2 Morning chai is the best chai
 3 Bengaluru has filter coffee and chai
 4 My amma makes masala chai
 5 chai and samosa in the rain
 6 Office chai is not like home chai
 7 Train chai costs ten rupees
 8 Cutting chai is famous in Mumbai
 9 chai chai chai shouts the vendor
10 Darjeeling chai comes from West Bengal
11 Assam also grows chai leaves
12 Irani chai with bun maska in Hyderabad
13 Ginger chai is good for cold
14 Last line of my chai file
Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT:~/practice3$
```

Screenshot 6: all the chai are back, because I did not save.

The file still has chai everywhere, but "from Shiva" is there and "Thank you" is gone, because I saved those changes before with :wq. So :q! only throws away the changes after the last save.

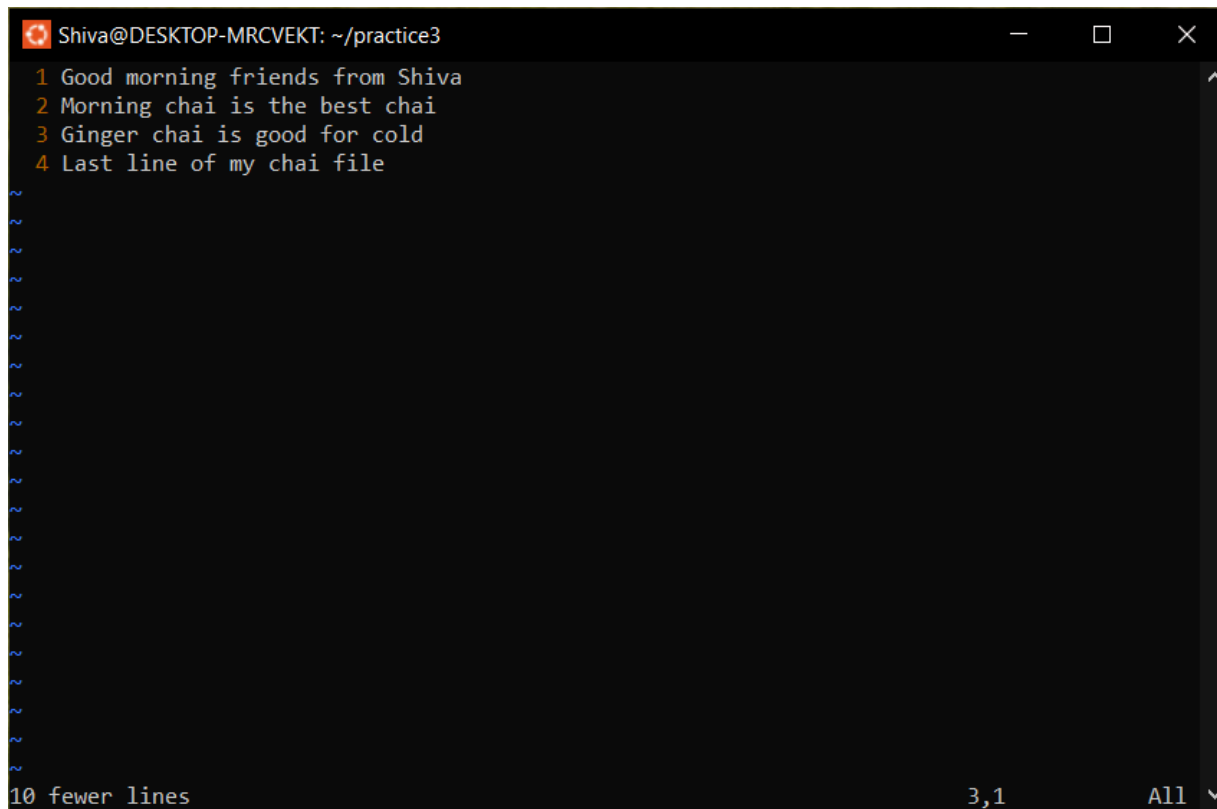
Deleting 10 lines at once - 10dd

```
vi chai.txt
```

```
:set nu
```

```
3G
```

```
10dd
```



The screenshot shows a terminal window titled "Shiva@DESKTOP-MRCVEKT: ~/practice3". The vi editor is open, displaying the contents of "chai.txt". The first four lines are visible: "1 Good morning friends from Shiva", "2 Morning chai is the best chai", "3 Ginger chai is good for cold", and "4 Last line of my chai file". Below these, there are several lines of tilde (~) characters, indicating that the rest of the file has been deleted. At the bottom left of the editor, the status "10 fewer lines" is shown. At the bottom right, the status "3,1" and "All" are visible, indicating the current cursor position and the scope of the deletion.

Screenshot 7: 10dd deleted lines 3 to 12.

From line 3, 10dd deleted 10 lines, that is lines 3 to 12. Only 4 lines are left, and at the bottom vi says 10 fewer lines. I did not want to lose my file, so I came out with :q! again without saving.